

Julian Skirzyński

CURRICULUM VITAE — OCTOBER 2026

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EDUCATION	University of California, San Diego <i>Ph.D. Candidate in Computer Science & Engineering</i> Thesis: Foundations of Human AI Interaction Advisor: Berk Ustun	2022 – PRESENT
	McGill University <i>M.S. in Computer Science</i> Thesis: Language-Conditional Imitation Learning Advisor: David Meger	2017 – 2020
	University of Warsaw <i>M.S. in Cognitive Science</i> <i>B.S. in Mathematics, Cognitive Science</i> Advisors: Andrzej Skowron; Piotr Wasilewski	2012 – 2018
ACADEMIC POSITIONS	Max Planck Institute for Intelligent Systems, Germany <i>Research Scientist</i> Projects: Interpretable RL Policies, Improving Human Planning, Discovering Human Planning Strategies Advisor: Falk Lieder	2019 – 2023
RESEARCH INTERESTS	Areas: Machine Learning, Cognitive Science, Human-Computer Interaction Topics: Decision-Making, Interpretability, AI Alignment, Reinforcement Learning, Experimental Design Applications: Social Sciences, Medicine, Consumer Finance, Criminal Justice	
AWARDS & HONORS	Pierre Arbour Foundation Scholarship McGill University Graduate Excellence Award McGill - University of Warsaw Exchange Scholarship University of Warsaw Academic Excellence Scholarship	2018 – 2019 2018 2015 2014 – 2017
PREPRINTS	1. What Went Wrong? Structured Self-Debugging for LLM Agents Julian Skirzyński, Berk Ustun <i>In Submission, 2026</i> 2. Decorative Rationalization in Large Language Models Julian Skirzyński, Berk Ustun <i>In Submission, 2026</i> 3. On the Value of Interpretability in Human Decision-Making Julian Skirzyński, Elena Glassman, Berk Ustun <i>In Preparation, 2025</i>	
PAPERS	4. Measuring What Matters: Synthetic Benchmarks for Concept Bottleneck Models Julian Skirzyński, Harry Cheon, Shreyas Kadekodi, Meredith Stewart, Berk Ustun <i>Annual Conference on Neural Information Processing Systems, 2026</i> 5. Quantifying Cognitive Bias Induction in LLM-Generated Content Abeer Alessa, Akshaya Lakshminarasimhan, Param Somane, Julian Skirzyński, Julian McAuley, Jessica Echterhoff <i>International Joint Conference on Natural Language Processing, 2025</i>	
	*EQUAL CONTRIBUTION	
		

6. [Discrimination Exposed? On the Reliability of Explanations for Discrimination Detection](#)
Julian Skirzyński, David Danks, Berk Ustun
ACM Conference on Fairness, Accountability, and Transparency, 2025
7. [Automatic Discovery and Description of Human Planning Strategies](#)
Julian Skirzyński, Yash Raj Jain, Falk Lieder
Behavior Research Methods, 2023
8. [Boosting Human Decision-making with AI-Generated Decision Aids](#)
Frederic Becker*, Julian Skirzyński*, Bas van Opheusden, Falk Lieder
Computational Brain & Behavior, 2022
9. [Automatic Discovery of Interpretable Planning Strategies](#)
Julian Skirzyński, Frederic Becker, Falk Lieder
Machine Learning, 2021
10. [Object \[Re\] Cognition with Similarity](#)
Łukasz Sosnowski, Julian Skirzyński
International Conference on Information Processing and Management of Uncertainty in Knowledge-Based Systems, 2018
11. [A Framework for Analysis of Granular Neural Networks](#)
Julian Skirzyński
International Joint Conference on Rough Sets, 2017

REFEREED
WORKSHOP
PAPERS

12. [On Interpretability and Overreliance](#)
Julian Skirzyński, Elena Glassman, Berk Ustun
Interpretable AI: Past, Present and Future, NeurIPS Workshop, 2024
13. [Language-Conditional Imitation Learning](#)
Julian Skirzyński, Bobak Baghi, David Meger
Visually Grounded Interaction and Language, NAACL Workshop, 2021

TEACHING

- UCSD Computer Science & Engineering Department 2026
[CSE101 – Design & Analysis of Algorithms](#)
Teaching Assistant
 Led discussion sessions for 300+ undergraduate students on the basics of theoretical computer science (graph theory, runtime, NP-completeness, etc.). Held weekly office hours and corrected homework.
- UCSD Halicioğlu Data Science Institute 2023
[DSC291 – Interpretability & Explainability in Machine Learning](#)
Guest Lecturer & Teaching Assistant
 Co-designed curriculum and held weekly office hours for serving 20+ PhD/MS students. Delivered guest lectures on ML interpretability methods and cognitive biases in AI-assisted decision-making. Completed teaching development workshop on graduate-level instruction.

SOFTWARE



- [Gestalt Dataset Generator](#) – Dataset for testing visual illusions in vision models
[Benchmark for Concept Bottleneck Models](#) – Dataset generators for testing different concept-based models
[Strategy Extraction from RL Policies](#) – Algorithm to extract interpretable decision trees from RL policies
[Human Planning Strategy Analysis](#) – Framework for identifying strategies used in human planning tasks

SELECTED INDUSTRY POSITIONS	Educational Entertainment One , Warsaw, Poland <i>Lead Technical Architect</i> Designed algorithms (AI, NLP) and supported the production process for a story-driven mobile game for learning English.	2021 – 2024
ACADEMIC SERVICE	JOURNAL REVIEWING Machine Learning CONFERENCE PROGRAM COMMITTEE NeurIPS – Conference on Neural Information Processing Systems ICML – International Conference on Machine Learning ICLR – International Conference on Learning Representations AAAI Conference on Artificial Intelligence FAccT – ACM Conference on Fairness, Accountability and Transparency ICML Workshop RL4RealLife – International Conference on Machine Learning IPMU – Information Processing and Management of Uncertainty in Knowledge-Based Systems	 2022 2023 – PRESENT 2025 – PRESENT 2024 – PRESENT 2025 – PRESENT 2022 – PRESENT 2021 2018
PERSONAL	Language Skills : English, Polish, German (Conversational) Software Skills : Python, R, C++, Flask, AWS, PyTorch, CPLEX, JavaScript, Jira Interests : Soccer, Groundhopping, Traveling, Fantasy Literature, Record Collecting Other : Peer tutoring, Co-author of “Triozy polskie”, a textbook for learning Polish by foreigners	